GEORGE WASHINGTON UNIVERSITY · *A Workflow Story*

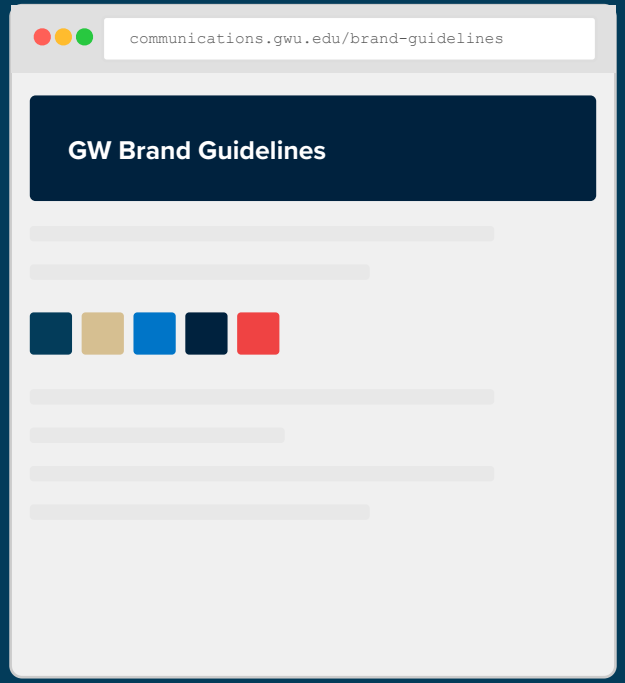
FROM WEBPAGE TO *SKILL*

How Claude read the brand guidelines and learned to design presentations in the GWU style — without being asked twice.

Lorena A. Barba | 3 April 2026

The work isn't the slides.

It's teaching Claude to make them.



communications.gwu.edu/brand-guidelines

GWU refreshed its brand.

New colors. New typefaces. New graphic elements drawn from campus architecture and the DC flag.

The guidelines live on three web pages — detailed, thoughtful, and written for designers, not for an AI.

The question was how to get that knowledge into Claude's hands, permanently and precisely.

1 EXTRACT

Claude on Chrome read the guidelines.

Using Claude’s browser extension, three pages of brand documentation were visited and distilled — keeping only what a slide designer needs: colors, type, and graphic elements.

No copy-pasting. No manual transcription. Claude read the pages and produced structured Markdown files, ready to use.



Claude on Chrome

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gwu-brand-specs.md

Colors · Typography · Accessibility

gwu-graphic-elements-guidelines.md

Chevrons · Gate Crossbar · Stars

Minimal. Structured.

Only what matters.

Three aspects of the brand — captured precisely.

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COLOR SYSTEM

10 named brand colors with tints. Exact hex values. WCAG AA–compliant pairings for every background.

GW Blue · GW Buff · Potomac · Navy Yard — plus five secondary accents.

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TYPOGRAPHY

Three brand typefaces with roles defined. Google Fonts substitutes identified for free use online.

Gazzetta → Playfair Display
Avenir Next → Nunito Sans
Source Serif → Source Serif 4

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GRAPHIC ELEMENTS

Chevrons, Gate Crossbar, and star motifs — each with specific rules for orientation, color, and placement.

One pattern per slide. Single color only. Consistent throughout the deck.

STEP TWO

Turning knowledge into a reusable skill

PREVIOUS SPEC

OLD-gwu-light-theme.md

EXTRACTED FROM WEB

gwu-brand-specs.md

EXTRACTED FROM WEB

gwu-graphic-elements-guidelines.md

↓

gwu-presentation.skill

Installable · Reusable · Always brand-correct

2 SYNTHESIZE

The skill-creator combined all three inputs.

Updated brand identity

New colors, typefaces, and graphic elements—replacing the outdated 2022 spec.

Presentation Zen built in

One idea per slide, signal over noise, images over bullets—woven into every layout rule.

Nine layout patterns

Cover, big idea, split, stats, tiles, divider, quote, image—each chosen by communication purpose.

THE RESULT

One installation. Brand-compliant by default.

Every future GWU presentation starts with the right colors, the right typefaces, and the right design principles — without looking anything up.



- Claude on Chrome reads brand guidelines
- Extracts structured Markdown files
- Skill creator synthesizes with Presentation Zen
- Packaged as an installable .skill file
- Total time: one afternoon